

grateful salute for displaying exemplary journalistic integrity and courage—rare in secular media—for telling us exactly what India has been reduced to by its Government.

Y.G. CHOUKSEY, *Pune*

What worries us more than the blasts themselves is the regularity at which they are carried out.

Why are our intelligence agencies not able to pre-empt such incidents?

R.D. SINGH, *Leh*

Medal Watch

Expecting bucketful of medals from just nine members of the Indian shooting team will be quite a far-fetched idea ("Company for Chilly", August 11). If the Indian contingent to the Beijing Olympics, which represents a nation of over a billion, wins even one or two medals, it would be fantastic.

BAL GOVIND, *Bareilly*

Matter of Faith

It was astonishing to know that Asaram Bapu owns property worth Rs 5,000 crore ("Clouded in Controversy", August 4). However, he seems too far away from the purview of the Government which seems to have turned a blind eye to his deeds, indeed. Why doesn't the Income-Tax Department initiate action against him for amassing wealth disproportionate to his income? What about his shady land deals across the country? Why doesn't anybody question the godman's rise from obscurity to riches?

RAHUL RAJAN, *on e-mail*

Left in the Lurch

The CPI(M) is justified in expelling Speaker Somnath Chatterjee for defying party order ("Expelled for Independence", August 4). But was it right to ask the Speaker to toe the party line? There are certain rules of democracy which the Marxists are yet to learn.

ASOKE C. BANERJEE, *on e-mail*

Somnath Chatterjee was expelled by the party because he chose to

perform his parliamentary duties with his head held high, quite literally. Chatterjee refused to step down from his post because he didn't want to lend his support to Prakash Karat's devilish plans of voting against the Government along with the BJP in the trust vote motion. By upholding the highest ideals of his post, Chatterjee has undoubtedly set an example for others to follow.

ANJANI KUMAR TIWARI,

on e-mail



The way the prime ministers and ministers are made in this country is highly disgusting ("Making of the Prime Minister", August 4). How can one expect clean and honest functioning from such individuals?

Perhaps we watched the ugliest side of democracy during the vote of confidence—dubious deals to win the numbers game. What message did this send across billions whose faith in the lofty ideals of democracy has been shaken once again?

DR HIMAL CHAND, *Chandigarh*

Prime Minister Manmohan Singh's conduct during the vote of confidence speaks volumes about him. He has learnt the business of politics, finally.

ROHIT KUMAR, *Mumbai*

Kudos to Manmohan Singh, who dared to risk his Government by refusing to bow down to the diktats of the Left and winning the trust vote in Parliament.

GANTI MAHAPATRUNI RAMA RAO, *on e-mail*

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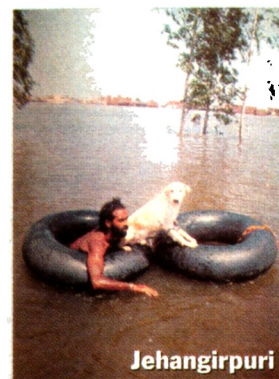
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Years Ago in India Today

SEPTEMBER 16-30, 1978



Unending Nightmare

Breaking all barriers and records of nearly a century, the rivers of north India conspired with the monsoon to erode signs of civilisation. Sweeping through the state of Haryana, sections of the capital Delhi, and through the landscape of Uttar Pradesh, Bihar and West Bengal, the fury of flood spelt death, destruction and disease. Capital's sprawling resettlement colony Jehangirpuri presents a dismal scene. The tarred road to the settlement peters out into a mussy pond; the crumbling tops of a few houses could be sighted some metres away; and a placid sheet of gently rippling water had virtually erased whatever remained of the eyesore created by contemporary urban planning. In less than two days, nearly all of the 1,30,000-strong population of Jehangirpuri had been evacuated. The few who remained marooned slept on the rapidly disintegrating rooftops to guard their belongings.

—Sunil Sethi, Arul B. Louis and Prabhu Chawla